



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	25/10/2022	Time of Incident:	13:30
Directorate / Region:	CNR, Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	28783
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Arborist Stung by Swarm of Bees
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What Happened:

Following a single vehicle crash where a truck struck a tree, a vegetation management company was engaged to cut the tree away from the truck so it could be recovered by the tow truck service. Emergency services and Main Roads personnel were also present at the crash scene.

After conducting a visual inspection of the tree, the IP cut off multiple branches, and was to commence chopping the top of the main trunk of the tree from an Elevated Work Platform EWP. After placing the first cut into the trunk, a swarm of bees came out from the tree, surrounding the IP.

The IP and ground crew, including emergency services, were stung during the event. Upon observing the swarm of bees, a colleague of the IP lowered the EWP basket.

As the IP is allergic to bees, their Epi-pen was administered immediately. Another Epi-pen was administered approx. 15 minutes later as the first had no effect. The second Epi-pen provided some relief, and the IP took some antihistamine (Telfast) to further reduce the effects of the allergic reaction.

The IP was then transported to the nearest medical facility by one of the onsite fire trucks, where their condition was assessed and then taken to the Joondalup Hospital to remain under observation.

The hospital confirmed the IP had been stung 73 times.

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert.

Immediate Actions:
Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- Follow the emergency management procedure
- Suggest notifying your supervisor or colleague if you are allergic to bees and if an Epi-pen is required

Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations
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